

GUEST LECTURE (17.06.25)

THE FEAR OF BEING THE OTHER

Identity and Play at the Margins



Kseniia Harshina, 2025

Guest Lecture (17.06.25): The Fear of Being the Other: Identity and Play at the Margins



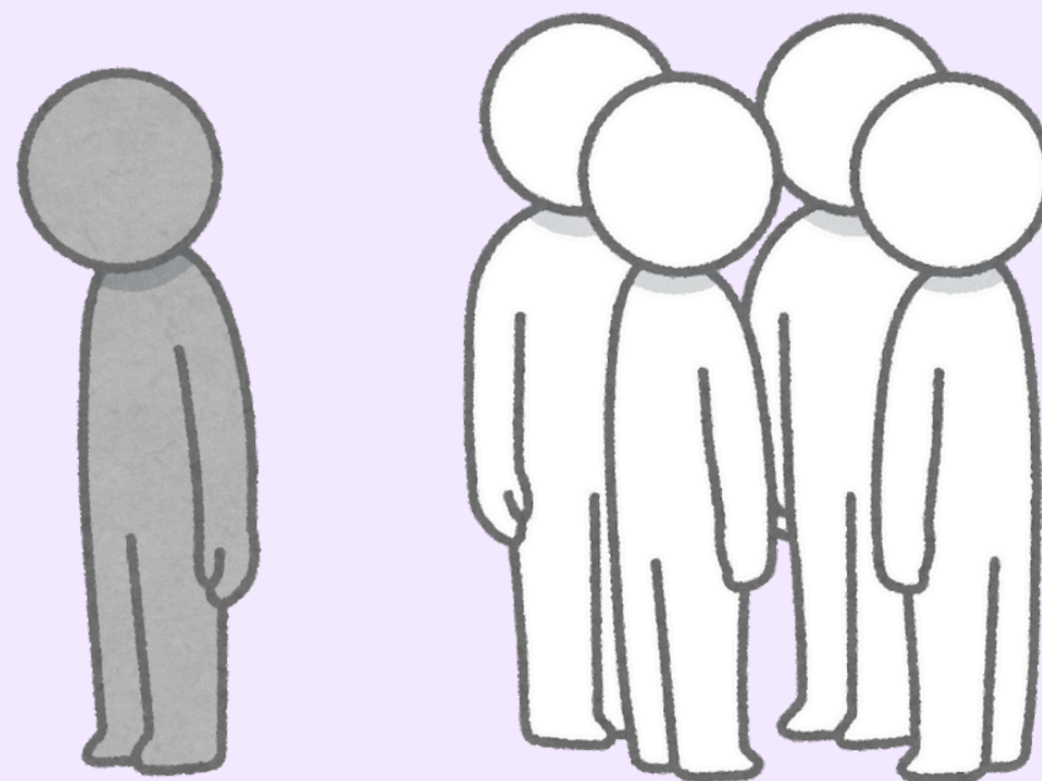
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WHAT COMES TO MIND WHEN YOU HEAR THE WORD 'OTHER'?



OTHERNESS

“Otherness” is how groups construct outsiders to maintain social boundaries (Said, 1978; Ahmed, 2004). It’s less about ‘who’ someone is and more about how they are made different.



THEORIES OF OTHERNESS



Julia Kristeva – The Abject

Gloria Anzaldúa – Borderlands

Bo Ruberg – Queer games

Stuart Hall – Identity construction

W.E.B. Du Bois – Double Consciousness

bell hooks – Oppositional Gaze

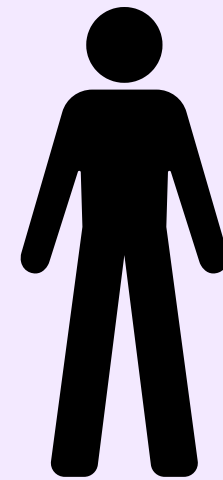
THE FEAR OF BEING THE OTHER VS. THE FEAR OF THE OTHER

**Fear of the Other: rooted in
xenophobia, racism,
transphobia, etc.**

**Fear of being the Other: fear
of rejection, erasure, being
made into a threat**

OTHERNESS IN CULTURAL CONTEXTS

Individualist Otherness



Collectivist Otherness

OTHERNESS IN CULTURAL CONTEXTS

Colonialism Constructs Otherness to **justify domination**

Otherness is not a static label; it's constructed through **power relations.**



  **A VERY SHORT HISTORY OF THE MONSTROUS**

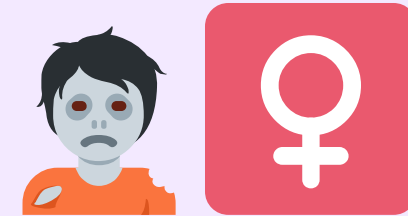


A VERY SHORT HISTORY OF THE MONSTROUS



Monsters represent what society rejects or represses

WHAT "MONSTERS" OR CREATURES ARE FEARED IN YOUR CULTURE?



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THE ARTIFICIAL OTHER



THE ARTIFICIAL OTHER: BLADE RUNNER (1982)



Blade Runner → Replicants as Other: human-like, but not human enough



CHATGPT AND WHO?

FEAR OF BEING OTHER: JORDAN PEELE



FEAR OF BEING OTHER: GET OUT

Get Out → Chris in Get Out is acutely aware of how others perceive him (the subtle racism, the exoticization of his Black body), and Peele visualizes this with the concept of the “Sunken Place.”

Metaphor for double consciousness: being trapped, “acutely aware of [one’s] own reflection in the eyes of others,” unable to fully act as oneself



FEAR OF (BEING) OTHER: US

Us → Shadow selves: the parts society hides, forgets, or punishes



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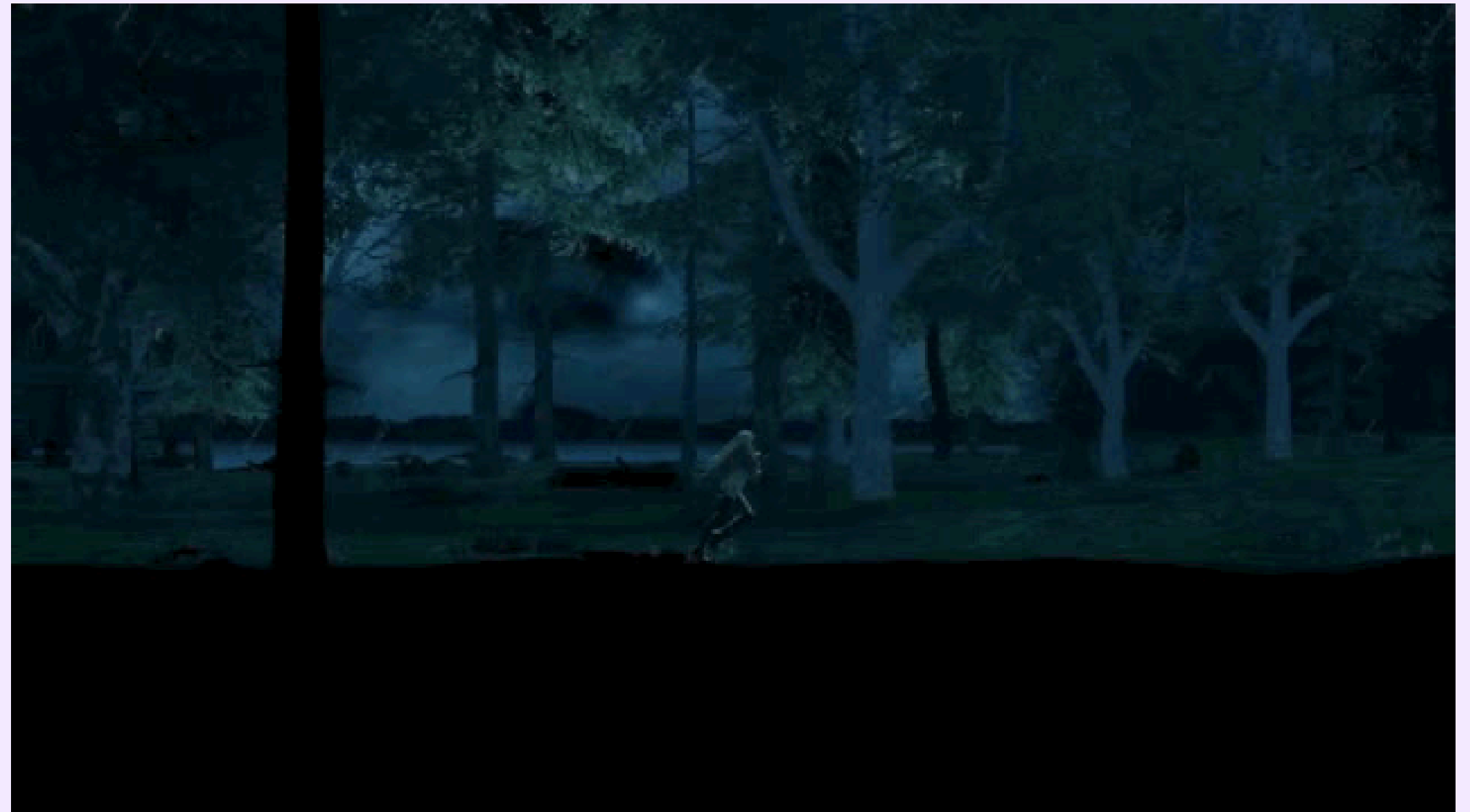


VIDEO GAME CASE STUDIES



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THE MISSING: J.J. MACFIELD AND THE ISLAND OF MEMORIES (2018)



VIDEO GAME CASE STUDIES



INSIDE (2016)

VIDEO GAME CASE STUDIES

SOMA (2015)



VIDEO GAME CASE STUDIES



HELLBLADE: SENUA'S SACRIFICE (2017)

VIDEO GAME CASE STUDIES : COUNTER EXAMPPLE



THE SIMS SERIES (2000–PRESENT)

the Other only exists as a concept because someone drew a line.

Confronting the fear of Otherness is the first step toward moving beyond it



Ultimately, the antidote to the fear of being the Other that we see across these narratives is Acceptance and Pride.



**THANK YOU
FOR JOINING!**

